

Stefano Romano

Experienced data and product leader

Product-minded data leader with 10+ years of experience in both startups and big tech. I combine a PhD-level scientific background with full-stack expertise across data engineering, data science and analytics. My core strength is in building high-performing data teams from the ground up, but in recent roles I expanded into technical product management of data/AI-centric applications. I do my best work in roles that combine technical depth, people leadership and product strategy

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Dovetail

Senior Manager, Data

11/2024 - Present

Sydney, AU

Dovetail is a Series A B2B SaaS business building an AI-native platform for customer intelligence

Achievements

- Drove operational efficiency by rebuilding the data platform from scratch, resulting in 70% cost savings and enabling the team to shift focus from primarily reactive work to primarily proactive
- Brought structure, clarity and motivation to a struggling data team, transforming it into a high-performing team in less than 1 year
- Raised the bar of Dovetail's data culture. Resolved long-standing inconsistencies in company metrics, driving trust in the data and enabling better informed decisions at the leadership level, including a major restructuring of the business
- **Tech stack:** snowflake, dbt, fivetran, census, metabase, hex, postgres
- From November 2025, expanded scope acting as **Technical Product Manager** for the data backend of Dovetail's core product, reporting to the CEO. Responsible for the data ingestion and AI analysis pipelines that power Chat, Agents, Search, AI Docs, Dashboards and MPC Server

Contact: Sascha Kerbert (VP of Ops) – sascha@dovetail.com

Sequence

Product Manager – Data, Analytics and Integrations [🔗](#)

02/2024 - 11/2024

Auckland, NZ

Sequence is an AI-backed, early-stage startup building modern billing infrastructure for sales-led businesses

Achievements

- Multi-disciplinary lead across product, data and engineering, encompassing several product areas: embedded analytics, integrations, AI-assisted workflows, core data platform
- Engaged regularly with customers as a technical expert. Unlocked 3 trajectory-changing deals by driving clarity on technical requirements and hands-on implementation support
- Worked with the leadership team and investors to adjust the company strategy to the new AI wave, acting as a domain expert

Contact: Riya Grover (CEO) - riya.grover@sequencehq.com

Sequence

Director of Data Engineering

11/2021 - 02/2024

Auckland, NZ

Achievements

- Early hire, reporting to the CEO, responsible for building out a data function spanning product analytics, customer-facing insights and AI-driven applications. Set up the data stack, designed the architecture and built the core data pipelines
- Involved at the leadership level in every aspect of building a company from the ground up – from hiring the initial team to setting up business operations, establishing a go-to-market strategy and driving a high-performance culture
- **Tech stack:** gcp, python, dbt, bigquery, postgres, metabase

Contact: Matt Collinge (CTO) - matt.collinge@gmail.com

WORK EXPERIENCE

Improbable

Engineering Manager – Applied Science [↗](#)

01/2021 - 08/2021

London, UK

Improbable is a late-stage startup building large-scale simulation technology for gaming, training and decision support

Achievements

- Line-managed a team of 15 Data Scientists and ML engineers, responsible for designing and implementing complex multi-domain simulations for government customers
- Led the delivery of 3 high profile technology demonstrators leading to multi-year contracts with the UK Ministry of Defence
- Redesigned the interview process, grew the team by 30%, improved the performance review process by establishing a career ladder framework, managed capacity planning and allocation across multiple concurrent projects with fast-shifting priorities
- **Tech stack:** python, luigi, R

Contact : Angelico Fetta (Senior Engineering Manager) - [linkedin.com/in/angelicofetta](https://www.linkedin.com/in/angelicofetta)

Improbable

Engineering Manager – Research Science

02/2020 - 04/2021

London, UK

Achievements

- Led a team of 6 Research Scientists focused on step-change innovation in complex systems simulations. Research topics included agent-based modelling, Bayesian inference, high-performance computing and machine learning
- Led the transition of the team from academically focused to a product-first, customer-centric mindset. Laid out a research strategy, drove internal alignment and implemented processes to connect Research to Product Development
- The team was [directly involved](#) in supporting the government's COVID-19 response through country-scale pandemic simulations and published 6 [research papers](#) in academic and industry conferences
- **Tech stack:** python, julia, pytorch, numba

Contact : Christoforos Anagnostopoulos (Principal Scientist) - canagnos@imperial.ac.uk

Individual Contributor Roles

Data Scientist

10/2013 - 02/2020

London, UK

Companies

- **Improbable** (07/2018 -02/2020): Technical lead for the scientific modelling team, responsible for designing multi-domain simulations for government customers. Blend of methods including probabilistic programming, unsupervised learning, procedural generation and network science. *Tech stack: python, R, julia, luigi*
- **Facebook** (08/2016 - 06/2018): Embedded role in a product team building a measurement tool for offline advertisers, leveraging geolocation data and machine learning to estimate the impact of advertising campaigns on visits to physical stores. Responsible for designing and evaluating the core statistical estimation pipeline. *Tech stack: SQL, python, airflow*
- **YouGov** (05/2015-07/2016): Part of the Centre of Statistical Excellence team, supporting both custom research projects and product development initiatives. Mix of data engineering, ad-hoc advanced analytics and prototyping new data products, e.g. an anomaly detection tool for brand reputation data. *Tech stack: R, python, SQL, AWS, Redshift, luigi*
- **Gamesys** (10/2013-05/2015): Player behaviour modelling to predict retention and lifetime value. *Tech stack: R, python, SQL*

SKILLS

Python

SQL

dbt

Startups

Data Science

Modern Data Stack

GCP/AWS

DataOps

Machine Learning

Statistics

Product Management

People Management

Leadership

Hiring

POSTGRADUATE EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher in Mathematical Physics

Université catholique de Louvain [↗](#)

01/2013 - 10/2013

Louvain-la-Neuve

PhD in Mathematical Physics

International School of Advanced Studies [↗](#)

2008 - 2013

Trieste, Italy